

A New Season of Nature Walks is Coming Soon

Rolando Jordan

Hello Nature lovers, we are excited announcing the 2026 season of nature walks in our home city, Sammamish.

Passion for Nature is a program hosted by Sammamish Friends, pursuing to Bring Sammamish Together as our mission statement declares, offering a monthly walk to appreciate the local wonderful sites that surrounds our city.

This year the walks will start in April 11, every second Saturday up to September. All the walks will start sharp at 9:00 am and could take from 1 to 2 hours each.

Safety is our main priority, for that reason we need to ask all the participants to wear long sleeves on top and bottoms, closed comfortable shoes, a hat or cap, and a raincoat if needed. Please don't bring umbrellas, heavy backpacks or anything that can harm yourself, anybody else, or the environment.

If you plan to bring snacks or beverages, please save the trash and dispose it properly or at your home. No dogs, strollers, bikes, music boxes, please.

Sorry to be so picky but these rules allow everybody to enjoy the nature properly.

Around our city we found plenty of greenery, nice forests, plants, flowers, and creatures. The views are stunning almost everywhere and depending on the weather we can enjoy different types of experiences; I'll make sure that everybody learn something interesting every walk.

This year Sammamish Friends is planning to count with some binoculars for the attendants in a base of first to come first to get.

Sign the release form available at the online register, please include your email and a contact cell phone to be in touch in case is needed. Only in cases of extreme weather or any other public warning we could cancel the event. No cancelations for rain, be prepared for it.

The past year we enjoyed great experiences together, this year we are adding some exciting places that includes Big Rock Park North, Evans Creek Preserve, a segment of the future Emerald Necklace Trail, Lake Sammamish State Park, Soaring Eagle Regional Park, and Yellow Lake Park at Klahanie.

Let's meet at the woods!

Passion for Nature

Abstract

Where: Big Rock Park North

Address: 21805 SE 8TH ST, Sammamish, WA, 98074

Google Maps: 47.60175, -122.04891

When: Saturday April 11, 2026. 9:00 AM – 10:30 AM

Please Park in the designated areas only

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday April 11th, starting at 9:00 am at Big Rock Park North. This is our first walk of the year, let's start calm and easy. Our meeting point will be the parking lot, look for the green flag.

Be prepared for a short and easy walk of 1.8 miles, mostly flat, natural surface, and paved in some areas. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

The highlights of this trail are the botanical garden, the tree house, the Owl Pond, and many more. Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish. No umbrellas please, wear a raincoat, cap, or enjoy the weather as it comes.

We will walk around and finish on the parking lot. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them, we would have some additional ones to lend.

In the future probably we will offer doggy, stroller, and/or wheelchair friendly walks. But because of the features of this trail, this walk is not for it.

This walk will be enjoyed better for people 12 years and older, please remember that any noise, music, strong talking, running, or walk outside the marked trail, could ruin the experience of the other participants, lets enjoy respectfully.

Left the place exactly as we found it or better. Drink only water, don't smoke anytime, attend the instructions of your guide all the time, and be prepared to have fun, learn interesting facts and be witness of the beauty of our local natural areas.

Guide: Rolando Jordan. 20+ years birdwatching. 10+ years of experience guiding tours in the jungles of Central America and other countries. Local enthusiast volunteering to make our community to appreciate what we have in our surroundings.

Passion for Nature

Abstract

Where: Evans Creek Preserve

Address: 4001 224TH AVE NE, Redmond, WA, 98053

Google Maps: Evans Creek Preserve

When: Saturday May 9, 2026. 9:00 AM – 10:30 AM

Please Park in the designated areas only

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday May 9th, starting at 9:00 am at Evans Creek Preserve. This walk has elevations up to 177ft, but still easy. Our meeting point will be the parking lot, look for the green flag.

Be prepared for a short walk of 2 miles, some little hills paths will be covered, natural surface, and some muddy areas. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

The highlights of this trail are the beautiful forested area, a flower covered field, the meadow, and many more. Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish. No umbrellas please, wear a raincoat, cap, or enjoy the weather as it comes.

We will walk around and finish on the parking lot. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them, we would have some additional ones to lend.

In the future probably we will offer doggy, stroller, and/or wheelchair friendly walks. But because of the features of this trail, this walk is not for it.

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Abstract

Where: Emerald Necklace Preview

Address: 4607 E Lake Sammamish Pkwy NE, Sammamish, WA, 98074

Google Maps: Sammamish Landing Park

When: Saturday June 13, 2026. 9:00 AM – 10:30 AM

Please Park in the designated areas only

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday June 13th, starting at 9:00 am at a segment to the Emerald Necklace Trail. The Emerald Necklace is a project of SAMMAMISH FRIENDS that will bring an entire loop around our City of Sammamish. At this moment several steps have been completed but still hard work needs to be done to complete this dream. During this event, we will learn about the project, the status of it, will walk in a small percentage of the completed trail, check the highlights, and walk back to the initial point. This walk is easy, flat, and paved. Our meeting point will be the parking lot, look for the green flag.

Be prepared for a short walk of 2 miles, all the way long is flat and paved. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

The highlights of this trail are the beautiful views of Lake Sammamish all the way long. Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish. No umbrellas please, wear a raincoat, cap, or enjoy the weather as it comes.

We will walk around and finish on the parking lot. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them, we would have some additional ones to lend.

This walk will be enjoyed better for people 12 years and older, please remember that any noise, music, strong talking, running, or walk outside the marked trail, could ruin the experience of the other participants, lets enjoy respectfully.

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Abstract

Where: Lake Sammamish State Park

Address: 2182 NW Sammamish Road, Issaquah, WA, 98027

Google Maps: Tibbetts Beach

When: Saturday July 11, 2026. 9:00 AM – 11:00 AM

Participants needs a Discover Pass, or pay the parking fee

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday July 11th, starting at 9:00 am at Lake Sammamish State Park. We will meet at the Parking Lot in front of the Tibbetts Beach, please use the initial parking spots in front of the main Gazebo, I'll be there, look for the green flag. This beautiful park offers great opportunities to see several bird species, including Bald Eagles, waterfowl, etc. The lake views are stunning, and the grounds invites to a picnic or just laid on the grass.

Be prepared for a short walk of 2 miles, all the way long is flat and paved, but we can enter to the sand at the beach or reach some muddy terrain. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

The highlights of this trail are the beautiful views of Lake Sammamish all the way long, the Bald Eagles (if we are lucky) among others. Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish. No umbrellas please, wear a raincoat if needed, cap, or enjoy the weather as it comes.

We will walk around and finish on the parking lot. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them, we would have some additional ones to lend.

This walk will be enjoyed better for people 12 years and older, please remember that any noise, music, strong talking, running, or walk outside the marked trail, could ruin the experience of the other participants, lets enjoy respectfully.

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Abstract

Where: Soaring Eagle Regional Park

Address: 26015 E Main Dr, Sammamish, WA, 98074

Google Maps: Soaring Eagle Regional Park

When: Saturday August 8, 2026. 9:00 AM – 11:00 AM

Please Park in the designated areas only

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday August 8th, starting at 9:00 am at Soaring Eagle Regional Park. We will meet at the Parking Lot, look for the

green flag. This is a moderate trail, with beautiful, forested area, and very basic natural trails.

Be prepared for a short walk of 2 miles, all the way long has rocks, could be muddy, and irregular. Please wear trekking boots or any shoes that protect your feet from rocks and roots. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

The highlights of this trail are the very basic paths, full of flowers, plants and creatures. Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish. No umbrellas please, wear a raincoat if needed, cap, or enjoy the weather as it comes.

We will walk around and finish on the parking lot. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them, we would have some additional ones to lend.

This walk will be enjoyed better for people 12 years and older, please remember that any noise, music, strong talking, running, or walk outside the marked trail, could ruin the experience of the other participants, lets enjoy respectfully.

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Abstract

Where: Yellow Lake Park

Address: 4210 244th PL SE, Issaquah, WA, 98029

Google Maps: Yellow Lake Loop Trail

When: Saturday September 12, 2026. 9:00 AM – 10:30 AM

Please Park in the designated areas only. There is a small parking lot on the side or along the street.

Detail

Welcome to our local nature appreciation activity on Saturday 12th, starting at 9:00 am at Yellow Lake Park – 4210 244th PL SE, Issaquah, WA, 98029. If you prefer, you can

park on the street in front of the Playground, or across the street in front of the baseball fields. The activity will start at the Playground (look for the green flag).

Be prepared for a short and easy walk of 1.6 miles (about 1.5 hour), mostly flat, natural surface, and paved in some areas. The walk will be at slow pace with multiple stops for interpret whatever nature wonder we found on our way. The focus will be birds, and other creatures, but we can appreciate mushrooms, flowers and other plants.

Wear comfortable long sleeve tops and bottoms, earth colors are preferred (birds are scared about white, cream, yellow or flashing colors), please wear comfortable closed shoes, bring some water, and little snacks if you wish.

We will walk around and finish on the lookout on the lake. Bring binoculars (any kind works), but you can enjoy the walk as well even without them.

In the future probably we will offer doggy, stroller, and/or wheelchair friendly walks. But because of the features of this trail, this walk is not for it.

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Rolando Jordan

Sammamish Washington Rolando_Jordan@hotmail.com

Nature Related Education

Certified Birdwatching tour guide, University of Panama 2015

Tropical Flora and Fauna Certificate, University of Panama 2018

Jungle survival diploma – APAVE 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019

Remote Areas Rescue diploma – APAVE 2018, 2019

CPR training certificate – American Red Cross, 2019

NAI Certified Interpreter – National Association for Interpretation, 2017

Volunteer Experience

Panama Rainforest Discovery Centre, Panama 2014-2019, Nature Guide
APAVE (Panamanian Association for Adventure and Hiking) 2014-2016, Member of the Board
APAVE (Panamanian Association for Adventure and Hiking) 2016-2019, President of the Board
ADOPTA Bosque Panama, 2018-2019, Conservationist
Sammamish Chamber of Commerce – 2024, Ambassador
Sammamish Chamber of Commerce – 2025, Board of Directors Member

Birdwatching and Hiking Experience

Tropical jungle, trekking, camping and hiking in Guatemala, Nicaragua, Panama, Mexico, and Brazil
Hiking in Washington State parks for 6 years
969 bird species observed worldwide
263 bird species observed in the US
227 bird species observed in Washington State
And many more coming ...

Apps and Resources

eBird (Cornell Lab)
Merlin (Cornell Lab)
AllTrails+
Check my resources in Facebook